

film reviews

Deathly Drone

DRONA

Rating: ★★★★★

Director: Goldie Behl

Starring: Abhishek Bachchan, Priyanka Chopra

What's a superhero without his props? Imagine Batman without his bat wheels, Spiderman without his web and Superman with no cape. Can't? Now watch *Drona*, a strong silent superhero battling villains carrying Ramlila axes and being guided by wannabe Gandalfs with fake white beards. In this supposedly state-of-the-art movie, the one bright spot, a leggy Priyanka Chopra flinging her limbs

about in a form of martial art that looks suspiciously like primary school taekwondo, is reduced to a sulking heap while Abhishek Bachchan's *Drona* scowls as he prowls. There is an arresting sword fight between Drona and the clownish villain Riz Raizada but it comes so late into the yawnathon that it has no impact. So where was the movie's Rs 55-crore budget spent? On Chopra's brocade cutaway coats? Or on the purple piggy bank masquerading as a treasure chest? There's an electric moment when Bachchan and Chopra are swinging together on a vine after she despatches a few faceless villains. But it looks like it's from another movie.

by Kaveree Bamzai

NO HORSEPLAY: Chopra and Bachchan



ARRESTED DEVELOPMENT: Imraan Khan in the movie

film review

Bikini on the Run

KIDNAP

Rating: ★★★★★

Director: Sanjay Gadhvi

Starring: Imraan Khan, Sanjay Dutt, Minissha Lamba

Studly Sanjay Dutt looks at busty Minissha Lamba, clad in two strips of clothing, and says tremulously, "You're so grown up." Lamba, a little earlier, clad in another twin strips, turns to the sprightly Vidya Malvade, dressed in pencil skirt and top two sizes too small, and says, "Mom, you can't be

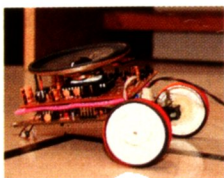
serious." Indeed. The unfortunate part of *Kidnap* is that Gadhvi thinks he's made an edge of the seat thriller. The only problem is it has audiences rolling in the aisles with laughter. With a rather bloated Dutt employing a body double even for sequences that require him to run and choir boy Imraan Khan trying hard to knot his unibrow into a frown, the cat and mouse game is reduced to a joke. Lamba wears a white bikini in various water bodies but all that *Rangeela*-type posing just gives poor miscast Khan a crick in the neck. And viewers a pain in the you know where.

KB

exhibition

Voice of Expression

MUMBAI BlindStars StarsBlind is an exhibition and a book by Shilpa Gupta, who uses language in a fragmented form of translation, where her art talks about regions and borders in a historical context. This is her first monograph exhibition, where performance plays a major role in demonstrating her ability to contextualise difficult contemporary subjects. The role of activism drives Gupta's many observations as she visually vocalises her deeply felt concerns about the plight of those who remain speechless. From October 11 to 30 at Bodhi.



A work on display

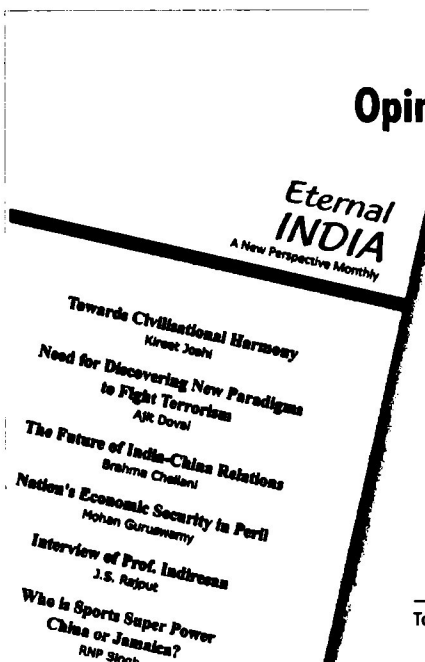
by Swati Mathur

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